

Chapter 77-3

When Su Yao called Sheng Qinglin and told him about this, Sheng Qinglin came back to the school that very afternoon and directly asked Su Yao: "Which ugly bastard is chasing after my sister?"

Su Yao was stunned, then asked angrily: "Shouldn't you be more concerned about me?"

Sheng Qinglin was also stunned: "Have you ever thought about anyone else?"

Su Yao: "....."

Sheng Qinglin wrapped his arm around Su Yao's shoulders, smiling with confidence and boldness: "There's no one better than me in this world."

At that time, Sheng Linlang was standing across from them, holding a camera she had just recently bought, and took a photo of the two of them.

Xu Qingzhu still remembered the photo album she had just flipped through, and asked: "Was it that one under the peach tree?"

"Yes." Sheng Linlang's voice was gentle, filled with endless nostalgia and longing, "Peach blossoms had even fallen on Su Yao's shoulder. I thought Su Yao was really beautiful at that moment."

"That photo was taken with a great sense of atmosphere." Xu Qingzhu praised.

Sheng Linlang smiled and said: "Really? I had just started learning photography back then and couldn't take good photos of anything yet. But those two were good-looking, so no matter how I photographed them, it wouldn't turn out bad."

But Xu Qingzhu asked: "How come I haven't seen you take photos all these years? Staying cooped up at home all the time, it's easy to get sick from being so shut in."

Hearing this, Sheng Linlang's expression changed slightly, but she gently closed her eyes and patted her shoulder while saying softly: "I did take photos of you kids when you were little. You lying on your desk, nestled in your room doing puzzles, swinging on the swing—so many, so many. Later when you all grew up, you wouldn't let me take photos anymore."

Sheng Linlang's movements were light and gentle, as if she were coaxing a child.

Her speech was very slow, softly and gently recounting the stories of those years. As she talked, Xu Qingzhu grew drowsy and soon fell asleep.

Sheng Linlang tucked the blanket around her, then lay on the bed and let out a soft sigh. Her gaze traced over those brows and eyes that looked so much like Sheng Qinglin's, and she said in a low voice: "You have to be well."

Only then would it not let down everyone's protection of you.

Having heard so much about Sheng Qinglin and Su Yao these past few days, Xu Qingzhu even dreamed about the two of them.

They were holding hands freely on campus, traveling to the seaside.

The dream had a soft filter over it, and Xu Qingzhu seemed to have taken on Sheng Linlang's perspective.

Watching them freely and safely pass through their youth.

But after all the beauty, she arrived at that street corner again, where Sheng Qinglin had carefully changed into a well-tailored suit, holding flowers and a ring as he came to the place where he and Su Yao had agreed to meet, only to be tragically hit by a car and sent flying.

The scene suddenly turned black and white, interwoven with the color of blood.

"Beep— Beep—"

The phone rang, and Xu Qingzhu rolled over and felt for the warm phone.

Half of it had been pressed under her body, and she hadn't noticed at all.

She swiped to answer with her eyes half-closed, her head resting on one arm, tears falling onto the bedsheet. When she answered, her voice was hoarse, carrying the softness of having just woken up.

Having had a nightmare, she was subconsciously scared, so her response was somewhat choked with sobs, sounding like she was acting spoiled: "Mm?"

"You fell asleep?" Liang Shi's voice rang out in the room.

From the camera on Liang Shi's end, Xu Qingzhu's long hair fell down, landing on her white silk pajamas. Her entire face was bathed in the dim yellow light of the bedside lamp, casting a hazy glow over her entire being. Half her face was buried in the crook of her arm, her curled and upturned eyelashes fluttering slightly, yet she couldn't seem to wake from the nightmare—sad and sorrowful.

Xu Qingzhu's lips were a vivid red but somewhat dry. Her milky-white skin was so clean and luminous that no pores could be seen. With her eyes half-open, she looked like a languid cat.

After hearing Liang Shi's words, she let out another soft whimper, sniffled, and said: "Mm~"

She didn't want to open her eyes no matter what, but tears slid past the side of her nose, turning into glistening teardrops that gathered at the tip of her nose before gently falling onto the bedsheet.

Liang Shi asked gently: "Did you have a nightmare?"

Her voice was kept very soft, as if a feather was gently brushing against the tip of one's heart, carrying infinite tolerance and tenderness.

Hearing her voice, Xu Qingzhu furrowed her brows tightly, yet her tone became even softer. Even a single syllable was drawn out: "Mm~"

Liang Shi was about to speak when another person appeared in the camera frame.

Sheng Linlang found a tissue, leaned over and gently wiped away Xu Qingzhu's tears, got up to tuck the blanket around Xu Qingzhu, and then got out of bed.